

BYLAWS

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CHAPTER I: GENERAL PROVISIONS

Article 1: Name

- (1) An association named '**Stroke Action**' is hereby established between the subscribers to these bylaws, under the provisions of Law No. 90-53 of 19 December 1990 relating to freedom of association in Cameroon.
- (2) The name in French shall be '**Action AVC**'. The term 'AVC' is the abbreviation of the French expression 'Accident Vasculaire Cérébral'.
- (3) The association's motto is '**Together to defeat stroke**' in English and '**Ensemble pour vaincre l'AVC**' in French.
- (4) Stroke Action is neither an academic nor a vocational training institution, nor is it a healthcare organisation. Therefore, it does not award any diploma or degree, and does not provide any medical care.
- (5) Stroke Action is a non-profit, secular, apolitical association serving the public interest.

Article 2: Objective

The general objective of Stroke Action is to **help reduce the burden of stroke in Cameroon, in Africa and worldwide.**

To achieve this objective, Stroke Action is committed to:

- i. **Public education** to raise awareness of the risk factors for strokes, their symptoms, first aid procedures, available treatments and their mode of administration.
- ii. **Conducting research** to provide high-quality data to support and inform the actions of the Cameroonian government, specifically those of the Ministry of Public Health.
- iii. **Continuing medical education** of people involved in stroke prevention or treatment, through the organisation of conferences, seminars, workshops or similar events.
- iv. **Providing technical, financial or logistical support for stroke research.**
- v. **Providing technical, financial, logistical, moral or legal support** to healthcare facilities, professionals and institutions responsible for the care and support of patients with stroke and their families.

Article 3: Headquarters

- (1) The headquarters of Stroke Action are located in Nkoabang, Nkolafamba Subdivision, Mefou and Afamba Division, Centre Region, Cameroon.
- (2) Stroke Action may relocate its headquarters to any other location within the country or abroad by resolution of the General Assembly, and notify the relevant authorities as appropriate.
- (3) Stroke Action may carry out its activities throughout Cameroon and abroad, in accordance with the laws and regulations applicable in each jurisdiction.

CHAPTER II: STRUCTURE AND ORGANISATION

Article 4: Structure

The activities of Stroke Action are conducted by the following bodies:

- i. The Founder
- ii. The Executive Committee
- iii. Active members
- iv. Honorary members
- v. Possibly Patrons
- vi. Possibly a network of volunteers
- vii. Possibly support staff

Article 5: The Founder

The founder of Stroke Action is Dr KAMTCHUM TATUENE Joseph, a Cameroonian physician, Neurologist, Neuroscientist, and registered with the Cameroon National Medical Council under the number 6078/2010.

Article 6: The Executive Board

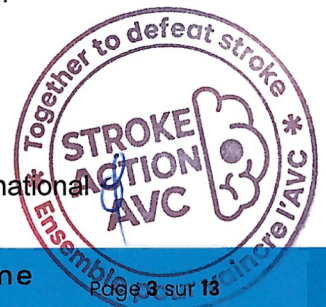
(1) Composition

The Executive Board of Stroke Action comprises five members:

- i. A President
- ii. A Secretary General
- iii. A Treasurer
- iv. An Auditor
- v. An Adviser

(2) Duties of the President

- a- He is the Founder of Stroke Action. In the event of temporary or permanent incapacity, a new Chairperson shall be elected in accordance with the procedures set out in Article 16.
- b- He always acts in collaboration with the Executive Board and the members of the association.
- c- He establishes the association's action plan and the corresponding budget in collaboration with the members of the Executive Board.
- d- He convenes and chairs meetings of the Executive Board and the General Assembly, setting the agenda for these meetings in collaboration with the Secretary-General.
- e- He defines the association's vision and missions.
- f- He is the sole signatory to the bylaws.
- g- He is the association's legal representative in all civil matters.
- h- He ensures compliance with the association's bylaws and with national and international



laws, charters and regulations.

- i- He ensures effective collaboration amongst the members of the Executive Board in order to achieve the missions of the association.
- j- He is the approved authorizer for all expenditures related to the association's activities.
- k- He signs the minutes of general meetings and the association's annual activity report, following ratification by the General Assembly.
- l- He co-signs all financial transaction orders with the Treasurer.

(3) Duties of the Secretary-General

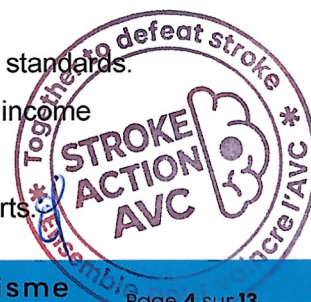
- a- He is responsible for implementing the association's action plan and projects. He therefore allocates tasks and supervises teams as required. He reports to the President.
- b- He is responsible for the association's operations, particularly in relation to communication, information and awareness-raising.
- c- He contributes to drafting the action plan and the budget.
- d- He writes the minutes of all Executive Board and General Assembly meetings.
- e- He writes and co-signs the association's annual activity report.
- f- He maintains the association's archives and the member register.
- g- He ensures compliance with the association's procedures and regulations and reports on this to the President.
- h- He keeps the attendance register and a record of any sanctions imposed.

(4) Duties of the Treasurer

- a- He is responsible for safeguarding the association's financial resources and assets.
- b- He assists in establishing the action plan and the budget.
- c- He co-signs all financial transaction orders with the President.
- d- He writes and signs the association's monthly and annual financial reports to supplement the annual activity report.
- e- He co-signs the association's annual activity report.
- f- In collaboration with the Auditor, he prepares external audit visits.

(5) Responsibilities of the Auditor

- a- He ensures that the association's financial and material resources are managed with transparency, rigour and parsimony.
- b- He assists in drafting the action plan and the budget.
- c- He ensures observance of internal procedures and compliance with financial standards.
- d- He implements control mechanisms that enable him to monitor expenditure and income against forecasts.
- e- He verifies and co-signs the association's monthly and annual financial reports.



f- In collaboration with the Treasurer, he prepares for external audit visits.

(6) Responsibilities of the Adviser

- a- He provides expertise and advice to the President and members of the Executive Board to inform their decisions, thereby facilitating the fulfilment of the association's mission.
- b- He carries out any task entrusted to him by the President or the Executive Board, provided that it does not conflict with the association's bylaws.

Article 7: Active members (or ordinary)

(1) An active member is any adult (aged 18 or over) whose:

- written membership application has been approved by the General Assembly,
- membership contributions are up to date,
- participation in the association's activities is effective,
- member status has not been revoked.

(2) Active members are required to participate actively (by attending regularly and punctually) in the ordinary meetings of the General Assembly.

Article 8: Honorary members (or extraordinary)

(1) An honorary member is:

- Any active member who has applied, by means of a written and reasoned request, to be transferred to the register of honorary members,
- Any adult who has accepted inclusion in the register of honorary members in recognition of services rendered to the association,
- Any adult who has accepted their appointment as a patron of Stroke Action.

(2) Unlike active members, honorary members are not required to attend General Assembly meetings punctually and regularly.

(3) The payment of membership fees is optional for honorary members, and they determine the amount themselves.

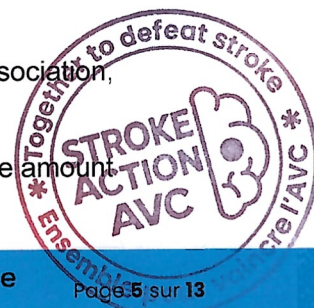
Article 9: Patrons

(1) A Patron is any adult of good character who shares the association's vision and objectives, whose status and reputation may help to enhance the association's national or international impact, and whose appointment has been approved by the General Assembly.

(2) Patrons participate in the association's meetings and activities according to their availability and are not bound by requirements regarding punctuality or regular attendance.

(3) Patrons may undertake independent initiatives to support and promote the association, provided they have first informed the Executive Board and obtained its approval.

(4) The payment of membership fees is optional for Patrons, and they determine the amount themselves.



Article 10: Acquisition and loss of membership

- (1) Acquisition of the status of active member, honorary member or patron is subject to the conditions set out in Articles 7, 8 and 9 above.
- (2) Only persons aged 18 or over may be members of Stroke Action. Any application for membership must therefore be accompanied by a valid identity document showing the applicant's date of birth and photograph.
- (3) Membership is not subject to any other restrictions based on profession, nationality, sex, religion, ethnic origin, social class, marital status, disability, pregnancy or maternity.
- (4) Active membership and honorary membership cannot be held concurrently. The active membership status is automatically lost by any active member whose application to be transferred to the register of honorary members is approved. Any active member who is temporarily or permanently unable to participate actively in ordinary General Assembly meetings or to pay their membership fees is eligible for such a transfer. A request for reversal of this transfer is possible if the person regains the capacity previously lost.
- (5) Every two years, members of the association are invited to propose individuals eligible for the status of Patron. Following a vote by the Executive Board, two individuals (ideally one man and one woman) are selected from among those proposed and will be appointed Patron by the President. Those concerned by such an appointment must have given their prior written consent. They automatically become Honorary Members of the association.
- (6) Unless they were already members, any member of the Executive Board automatically becomes an active member of the association upon their election or appointment. They are therefore required to pay membership fees.
- (7) Membership ceases under any of the following circumstances:
 - Death of the person concerned, confirmed by a death certificate or a record of death,
 - Voluntary resignation notified in writing to the President. The correspondence must be dated, and the member is free to choose the notification channel provided there is no ambiguity regarding their intention and identity: a signed letter (handwritten or typed), an email sent from a personal address, or electronic messaging (SMS, WhatsApp, etc.).
 - Expulsion by decision of the Executive Board, ratified by the General Assembly.
- (8) Expulsion (revocation of membership status or exclusion) may be imposed on the basis of a finding of serious misconduct evidenced by one or more of the grounds set out below, this list being indicative and not exhaustive:
 - Failure to pay membership fees where required to do so,
 - Failure to comply with the bylaws and/or the internal regulations,
 - Failure to fulfil contractual or statutory obligations,
 - Regular and unjustified absences,
 - Misappropriation of funds intended for the association's activities,



- Guilt established by a final court judgement in relation to acts of physical, psychological or sexual violence,
- Social behaviour detrimental to the association's activities or reputation,
- Support for activities or ideas contrary to those promoted by the association,
- Damage to the association's properties.

(9) Any proposal for expulsion shall be initiated by the Executive Board if supported by a simple majority of its members. The decision shall then be notified to the member concerned at least 30 days before the General Assembly meeting convened to ratify it. The member concerned may challenge the decision before or during the General Assembly meeting by presenting the necessary arguments in the forms permitted by the internal regulations. At the conclusion of the proceedings, the General Assembly shall rule on the matter immediately. The result of the vote is final and takes effect immediately. A Letter of Notification, dated and signed by the President, must be sent to the member concerned within 72 hours.

(10) Expulsion is irrevocable and automatically results in the loss of all Patron's privileges for any person who has previously received such a distinction. The person concerned is therefore required to take any notification or correction measures wherever needed.

(11) The loss of membership does not preclude claims for compensation for damage caused to the association, its members or its employees; nor does it preclude legal proceedings being brought against the person concerned before the competent courts in accordance with the procedures laid down by national and international laws, charters and regulations.

Article 11: The network of volunteers

(1) It comprises all persons aged 15 or over, of good character, who subscribe to the association's vision and objectives, and who wish to provide occasional support, in various forms, without being subject to the obligations of active members.

(2) Participation in the association's activities and meetings is open to volunteers. However, unlike members, they have only an advisory role at General Assembly meetings and do not have voting rights.

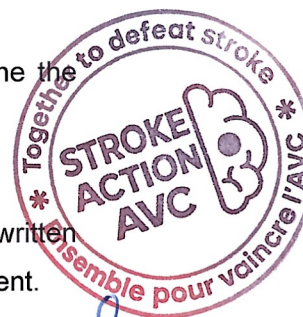
(3) Where they are under the age of 18, volunteers may only take part in activities organised by Stroke Action if they are accompanied by their parents or any responsible adults duly authorised by their parents.

(4) The payment of membership fees is optional for volunteers, and they determine the amount themselves.

Article 12: Acquisition and loss of the volunteer status

(1) To be listed on the volunteer register, any interested person must submit a written application stating their reasons, accompanied by a copy of their valid identity document.

(2) Apart from age, the status of volunteer is not subject to any other restrictions based on



profession, nationality, sex, religion, ethnic origin, social class, marital status, disability, pregnancy or maternity.

(3) Removal from the volunteer register is subject to the same conditions and procedures as those set out in Article 10 regarding removal from the member register.

(4) Membership and volunteer status cannot be held concurrently.

Article 13: Support staff

(1) Stroke Action may recruit technical staff as required to carry out specific one-off projects or to assist in implementing its action plan. This may include security officers, administrative staff, accountants, journalists or communication officers, logistics officers, legal advisers, and so on.

(2) Support staff working on a contractual basis are under no obligation to join the association or to pay any membership fees. They do, however, retain the right and freedom to submit a membership application, which will be registered and processed in accordance with the current bylaws.

CHAPTER III: OPERATIONS

Article 14: General Assembly

(1) The General Assembly comprises active members, honorary members and patrons of the Association.

(2) The General Assembly meets in two ways:

- **ordinary** meetings, held every six months (twice a year), convened by the President, who shall specify the agenda, date, time and venue at least 15 days (including weekends) before the meeting is held;

- **extraordinary**, as often as necessary to ensure the smooth running of the Association and the fulfilment of its objectives, convened by the President, who shall specify the agenda, date, time and venue at least 5 days (including weekends) before the meeting is held.

(3) In exceptional circumstances, the President may be required to convene an extraordinary meeting of the General Assembly by a simple majority of active members.

(4) Information regarding meetings of the General Assembly shall be communicated to members in writing, via the most appropriate channel, by the President himself or his authorised representative.

(5) If circumstances so require, General Assembly meetings may be held online via a carefully selected platform, provided that data security is guaranteed. In such cases, electronic signatures on documents may be accepted in accordance with the procedures defined and approved at the meeting.

(6) The validity and legality of General Assembly meetings are subject to:

- the presence (or valid representation) of at least two-thirds (2/3) of the active members,
- compliance with the notice periods and procedures for convening the meeting,
- compliance with the bylaws and with the laws and regulations governing the activities of associations in Cameroon.

If these conditions are not met, a new date must be proposed within 72 hours.

(7) The General Assembly's responsibilities are as follows:

- Election of members of the Executive Board where this method of appointment applies,
- Determination of the amount of annual membership fees,
- Ratification of the decisions and appointments made by the President or the Executive Board,
- Ratification of the minutes, financial reports (monthly/annual) and activity reports,
- Ratification of cooperation agreements with partner institutions,
- Deliberation on any matter on the agenda.

(8) All decisions of the General Assembly are taken by a simple majority through direct and public universal suffrage. In the event of a tie, the President's vote counts as two.

(9) In practice, outside formal meetings of the General Assembly, any decision taken by the President or the Executive Board must be communicated to the General Assembly within 72 hours. It is deemed ratified by the General Assembly if not contested by a simple majority within 7 days. The same principle applies to the ratification of minutes, financial reports and activity reports.

Article 15: Executive Board

(1) All members of the Executive Board of Stroke Action must hold the Cameroonian nationality.

(2) All members of the Executive Board, with the exception of the President and the Adviser, are elected at a General Assembly meeting for a five-year term, renewable twice at most. Any amendment to the bylaws during a term shall not affect either the duration of the current term or the number of remaining terms.

(3) Positions on the Executive Board may be held concurrently if circumstances so require, provided that the number of Board members remains three or more in order to facilitate decision-making and prevent authoritarian tendencies.

(4) Positions on the Executive Board are open to any adult aged 18 or over, in full possession of their civil rights and mental faculties, without any other restrictions based on profession, gender, religion, ethnic origin, social class, marital status, disability, pregnancy or maternity.

(5) Positions on the Executive Board, with the exception of those of President and Advisor, may be subject to a public call for applications depending on the association's staffing requirements. Applications are then submitted to the President, or to the secretariat where applicable.

- (6) The Advisor is appointed by the President for a five-year term, tacitly renewed. His term of office ceases in the event of resignation, dismissal, or at expiration of the term of the President who appointed him. Except for dismissal – which is irreversible – the Advisor may be reappointed. The act of dismissal is a prerogative of the President and must be justified.
- (7) The Executive Board holds regular monthly meetings to consider all matters relevant to the smooth running of the association's activities and the fulfilment of its objectives. For all decisions requiring an immediate vote, is the latter carried out by direct and public universal suffrage (verbal declaration) and the simple majority principle applies. In the event of a tie, the President's vote counts as two.
- (8) For all Executive Board meetings, the presence of at least three members is required and the President's attendance is mandatory, except in cases of force majeure.
- (9) If circumstances so require, Executive Board meetings may be held online via a carefully selected platform, provided that data security is guaranteed. In such cases, electronic signatures on documents may be accepted in accordance with the procedures defined and approved at the meeting.
- (10) Any member of the Executive Board may resign by submitting a written request to the President. The letter must be dated, and the member concerned is free to choose the method of notification. The member concerned retains their membership status after resigning from their post, provided that the conditions for membership continue to be met.
- (11) Any member of the Executive Committee may be compelled to resign by a petition initiated by an active member and signed by three-quarters (3/4) of the active members. The person concerned retains their membership status after stepping down from their post provided that the conditions for membership continue to be met.

Article 16: Replacement of the President

- (1) Should the President be unable to fulfil their duties, the Executive Board members shall handle day-to-day business. After a period of three months, the Secretary General shall declare the post vacant and call an election for a new Executive Board within 60 days. Members of the outgoing Executive Board may stand as candidates in that election. The President's mandate shall de facto become elective, with the same duration and conditions as those applicable to the other members of the Executive Board. The newly elected President shall appoint an Adviser, oversee the updating of the bylaws and notify the relevant authorities in accordance with the regulations in force.
- (2) The death or resignation of the President constitutes a de facto vacancy, which triggers the electoral process.
- (3) If a President who was previously unable to serve regains the capacity to hold office on

the Executive Board after the vacancy has been confirmed, he must stand as a candidate in the elections provided for in these bylaws. The principle of limitation of mandates remains applicable, and previous terms of office are taken into account.

CHAPTER IV: RESOURCES

Article 17: Origin of resources

(1) Stroke Action's resources are derived from various sources, including:

- The Founder's and members' own assets,
- Regular compulsory membership fees from active members,
- Voluntary contributions from honorary members and patrons,
- Proceeds from research or continuing professional development activities,
- Any other sources not contrary to the laws and regulations in force in Cameroon.

(2) Each active member is required to contribute to the association's activities for a minimum annual amount of 100,000 FCFA (one hundred thousand CFA francs), payable in a maximum of four equal instalments, and non-refundable. Consecutive quarterly instalments must not be more than 3 months apart. A surcharge of 1 per cent per calendar day of delay shall apply to the amount due for the quarterly or annual instalment.

Article 18: Management of resources

(1) Stroke Action's resources are allocated exclusively to activities contributing to the fulfilment of its objective as set out in Article 2 of these bylaws.

(2) The distribution of the association's resources or the proceeds derived from its activities for the purpose of enriching members is strictly prohibited. Only contractual salaries for support staff or legitimate compensations to members for specific services may be authorized, in accordance with a scale previously approved by the General Assembly.

(3) Stroke Action's financial resources are held in an account with a banking institution authorised by the Cameroonian Ministry of Finance. The said account is held in the name of Stroke Action and operates under a dual-signature system. All financial transactions must therefore be co-signed by two of the following three persons: the President, the Treasurer and the Auditor.

(4) All financial transaction orders exceeding 500,000 FCFA (five hundred thousand CFA francs) must be ratified in advance by the General Assembly.

Article 19: Membership benefits

Membership of Stroke Action confers the following benefits, the list being non-exhaustive and subject to change:

- Possibility to participate in research projects in line with one's skills, experience

and availability;

- Access to continuing professional development at preferential rates, with the possibility of receiving promotional codes for a specified number of partners, friends or relatives;
- Opportunity to receive letters of recommendation for job applications, scholarships or research grants;
- Opportunity to gain experience in volunteering or social activism, which enhances the CV;
- Free access to various items bearing the association's logo (pens, medical equipment, clothing, etc.);
- Scientific affiliation for publications or research grant management;
- Free or discounted access to some services offered by the association's partners.

CHAPTER V: SUPPLEMENTARY PROVISIONS

Article 20: Internal Regulations

- (1) Internal regulations supplement these bylaws and set out the procedures for their implementation.
- (2) The internal regulations shall be written by the Executive Board and submitted to the General Assembly for approval.

Article 21: Amendments to the bylaws

- (1) Any amendment to the bylaws must be initiated by the Executive Board and approved by the General Assembly.
- (2) Any amendment shall come into force upon its ratification and shall repeal any preexisting contrary provisions.
- (3) Any amendment must be notified to the administrative authorities by the President in accordance with the provisions of Article 7 of Law No. 90-53 of 19 December 1990.

Article 22: Suspension and dissolution

- (1) The procedures for the suspension or dissolution of Stroke Action, as well as the avenues of appeal, are set out in Articles 12, 13 and 14 of Law No. 90-53 of 19 December 1990.
- (2) Any dissolution initiated by the Executive Board of Stroke Action is subject to the approval of the General Assembly.
- (3) In the event of dissolution, Stroke Action's assets shall be used exclusively to settle its invoices, debts or liabilities. Any surplus shall be donated to one or more organisations, the list of which shall be determined by the General Assembly. Priority shall be given to non-profit organisations pursuing objectives similar to those of Stroke Action. The procedures for the liquidation of the association's assets shall be specified by the General Assembly in



accordance with national and international laws, charters and regulations.

Article 23: Disputes

Any dispute relating to the activities of Stroke Action must, as a matter of priority, be brought before the competent courts in Cameroon.

These bylaws were adopted at the founding General Assembly of Stroke Action held on 18 July 2026, convened to adopt the bylaws and elect Executive Board members.

Done in Nkoabang, on 18 July 2026.

STROKE
ACTION
AVC



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